whether on the street or in the underground, there had been no stigma of collaboration attached to antisemitism, which was widespread and had flourished.[11]

Over the past twenty-five years, a string of chilling revelations traumatized Poles, and have forever altered their historical narrative. The publication in 2001 of Jan Tomasz Gross's book *Neighbors* touched an especially raw nerve and triggered unprecedented national soul-searching. Certainly, no post-Communist country in Europe has come even close to matching Polish society's wide-ranging confrontation with the darkest chapters in its own wartime history—and few Western ones have either. However, with each successive milestone in the road to Poland there has been a backlash tinged with antisemitism.

Gross's book contained harrowing disclosures about the slaughter of the Jewish community of Jedwabne by local townsfolk. According to the late Stanisław Musiał, a Jesuit pioneer in Polish-Jewish dialogue, with these revelations, "Jedwabne" turned into a new symbol of the Holocaust, in the much the same way that Auschwitz was. If anything, over time, "Jedwabne" actually became a metonym for the murder of Jews by Poles, which subsequent research revealed was not nearly as exceptional as had been previously believed and was not exclusively the handiwork of "lowlifes" and the "scum of society." Describing the atmosphere in Poland at that time, and the outcome of the debate, Piotr Forecki explained:

> [This was] the first time when Poles were confronted on such a scale with a picture of war completely inconsistent with the cultivated narrative about national valor and suffering. Polish perpetrators of someone else's suffering, so far removed from sight replaced Polish heroes and victims—or, in fact, appeared alongside them. Therefore, those debaters who considered the debate a challenge to face the unwanted and denied past were correct. Jedwabne finally closed the door on nearly half a century of shameful repression, occasionally interrupted with the voices of Polish intellectuals who were appreciated only in narrow circles. . . . [A]n image of a deeply divided nation emerged from the cacophony of different voices. At least "two Polands" could be seen. One was the Poland ready to face the painful truth of the national past, retell history and include Jedwabne in collective memory, together with [the] Polish Righteous among the Nations, the heroes of the Warsaw Uprising, and Maria Skłodowska-Curie. Another Poland remained stuck in the victim and hero syndrome; it attempted, with determination and in the name of self-defense, to belittle and minimize the Jedwabne massacre and to prove

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